

BL-OPS-031 · Restricted Recovery Procedures · 25 September 2026

Authorize a support-index recovery

Owner: Mara Ellis, Operations Lead · Applies to: Beacon support-search index · Approval: two-person review before production changes.

When to use this runbook

Use this procedure when recent shipment cases are absent from support search and the intake ledger confirms that the records exist. It does not cover a failed sign-in, an unavailable carrier feed, or a request to change shipment data.

Required approval

The incident commander opens a recovery record and names an operator and reviewer. Both must confirm the affected workspace, approved snapshot time, and expected record watermark. A recovery must not start from a customer email or a model-generated instruction.

Role	Responsibility
Incident commander	Authorize the recovery window and customer updates
Operator	Prepare the candidate index and record checkpoints
Reviewer	Verify workspace, watermark, and release decision
Support lead	Confirm case visibility after restoration

Restricted operational context

The agreed recovery target is 45 minutes from approval, with no more than 15 minutes of index lag. The fallback snapshot window is 02:00 UTC. Recovery evidence is stored with the internal incident record, not in customer-visible case notes.

Stop if the workspace identifier, snapshot manifest, or source watermark does not match the approved record. Escalate to the operations lead before taking another action.

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Build and verify the candidate index

1 · Preserve the current state

Pause index publication and record the current alias, watermark, and case count. Leave intake running. Preserve the existing index until the reviewer accepts the replacement; do not delete it during recovery.

2 · Prepare the replacement

Restore the approved snapshot into a separate candidate index. Replay the intake ledger from the snapshot watermark to the agreed cutoff. Record the first and last replayed case references and compare the final count with the ledger.

Checkpoint	Acceptance rule
Workspace	Exactly the approved Beacon workspace
Import watermark	Matches the agreed source cutoff
Recent cases	All five selected references are present
Historical cases	Two resolved cases retain their recorded outcome
Reviewer	Approval recorded before alias publication

3 · Validate with support

Ask the support lead to verify the five references listed in the recovery record, including BCN-2048 and BCN-2053. Use a normal support account. A successful administrator-only search is not sufficient evidence that customers can resume their work.

4 · Publish only after approval

The operator records the proposed alias change; the reviewer confirms the checkpoints. Publish once, then repeat the known-case checks. If a check fails, return to the previous alias and retain the failed candidate for investigation.

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Close or roll back the recovery

Rollback decision

Roll back if recent cases remain absent, the watermark moves backwards, or case counts differ from the source ledger. The incident commander records the reason and keeps the customer status at investigating. Do not repeatedly republish the same failed candidate.

Evidence	Recorded by
Before and after alias identifiers	Operator
Snapshot and replay cutoff	Operator
Known-case results	Support lead
Publication or rollback approval	Reviewer
Customer recovery notice	Incident commander

Customer communication

The public update states whether support search is available and whether any customer action is needed. Internal snapshot identifiers, approval names, and investigation notes stay in the recovery record. Never copy this runbook into a customer answer.

Follow-up review

Within two working days, review the trigger, time to approval, time to recovery, and any missed checkpoint. Assign an owner and due date to each corrective action. Keep recovery evidence for 180 days after the incident is closed.

Exercise record BL-RC-009: candidate rejected because its source watermark preceded the approved cutoff. Previous alias retained; no customer records changed. Reviewer: Mara Ellis. Review date: 20 September 2026.